CHITY GROUP

Brand Usage and Governance

Rules, approvals and asset management

1. Purpose and scope

This document tells employees, agencies and vendors how to use the CHITY GROUP brand correctly and who approves what. It applies to materials issued by CHITY GROUP itself. Operating businesses follow their own brand rules and use the group identity only through the endorsement line described in Brand Architecture.

2. The essentials

AREA	THE RULE	WHERE TO FIND IT
Logo	Use only the supplied files. Never alter, retype or recolor. Keep a margin of X (the height of the C) on every side, and respect the minimum sizes.	Logo System
Color	Deep Navy or Cloud White as the base, blue as the accent. No text on the gradient. Copy HEX codes exactly.	Color Specifications
Typography	Montserrat Bold and SemiBold for headlines, Inter Regular and Medium for everything else. Arial where custom fonts cannot be used.	Typography and Licensing
Graphics	One brand curve at most. Rounded containers. The six pillar icons only.	Graphic Language
Imagery	A mix of people, structures, nature and abstract light. No single sector dominates.	Imagery
Voice	Clear, assured, evidence-led. Write CHITY GROUP in capitals.	Brand Strategy
Templates	Start from the supplied templates for cards, letters, presentations, email and social media.	Applications

3. Before you publish

Check every piece of external material against this list.

1. The logo comes from the supplied files and is unaltered.
2. The correct logo version is used for the background, at or above its minimum size.
3. Clear space is respected and nothing crowds the logo.
4. Only palette colors are used, and no text sits on the gradient.
5. Headlines are Montserrat; other text is Inter (or Arial in email and restricted software).
6. Text contrast passes the Color Specifications.
7. Images follow the Imagery document and have alternative text online.
8. The message uses approved descriptions and the CHITY GROUP name is in capitals.
9. Claims are supported by evidence. Nothing promises what cannot be delivered.
10. Material outside the standard templates has been reviewed (section 4).

4. Approvals

The Brand Owner is the person or team designated by group leadership to protect and approve the brand.

SITUATION	REQUIREMENT
Using supplied templates and files exactly as provided	No review needed.
A new template, layout or format	Brand Owner review before use.
External campaigns and launches	Brand Owner review before release.
Any change to the logo files, palette, fonts or guidelines	Brand Owner approval. Changes are made only by the Brand Owner.
A new operating business, or how it carries the endorsement	Brand Owner approval (see Brand Architecture).
Signage, vehicles and merchandise	Brand Owner review of artwork and a proof before production.
Use of the CHITY GROUP name or logo by a third party	Written permission from the Brand Owner.

Review process

1. Send the draft to the Brand Owner with its intended use, format and date.
2. The Brand Owner checks it against the list in section 3.
3. The Brand Owner replies with approval or specific changes.
4. Keep the approved final file in the asset library.

5. Agencies and vendors

SUPPLY	REQUIRE
The logo package (SVG files), the Color Specifications, Typography and Licensing, and the Logo System.	Use only the supplied files and fonts, with no redrawing or substitution.
The font files with their OFL.txt licenses.	Printed or screen proofs before production or publication.
The relevant template files.	Editable final artwork, plus the exported PDF, returned to the group.
The name of the Brand Owner as the single point of approval.	No use of the group's assets for other clients or purposes.

6. Asset management

- Keep all brand assets in one controlled shared location with the structure of the brand package.
- Name files with the convention CHITYGROUP_[Asset]_[Variant]_[Background]_[FORMAT].
- Store only current files in the working library. Move superseded files to an archive folder so they cannot be used by mistake.
- Keep editable sources (Word, PowerPoint, design files) beside the final exports.
- Record every new asset in the Asset Index.
- Give edit rights to the Brand Owner only; everyone else has read access.
- The Brand Owner reviews the brand documents at least once a year and whenever the group's structure, businesses or markets change, and issues updates to everyone who holds copies.

7. Operating businesses and partners

- Operating businesses keep their own identities. Their use of the group identity is limited to the endorsement line in its specified form.
- Joint materials with partners are reviewed by the Brand Owner. The CHITY GROUP logo keeps its clear space and is never combined into a new lockup.
- Partners and suppliers may use the CHITY GROUP name or logo only with written permission.

8. Correcting misuse

Report any incorrect or unauthorized use of the brand to the Brand Owner. The Brand Owner identifies the correct file or rule, asks the owner of the material to correct it, and confirms the replacement. Where a third party is involved, ask for the material to be withdrawn until corrected.